HelpEra:
Unbox Your Inner Clarity

Curtin University Dubai

UXplorers

Human Computer Interface ICTE 3002

1 OVERVIEW

HelpEra is a mobile mental health support application specifically designed for young adults. The project aims to bridge the critical gap between independent self-help and formal clinical intervention by providing a safe, non-clinical environment for emotional regulation. By focusing on accessibility and user-centred design, HelpEra empowers users to navigate daily emotional challenges with confidence and privacy.

2 THE CHALLENGE: BREAKING BARRIERS TO CARE

Modern young adults face unprecedented levels of stress and emotional exhaustion, yet professional therapy often remains inaccessible due to high costs, social stigma, or intimidating clinical processes. Our research identified a significant "pain point" where current digital tools either feel overly medical or lack a structured way for a user's social support network to offer help. There is a vital need for a low-barrier entry point that prioritizes secure, private reflection and immediate emotional support.

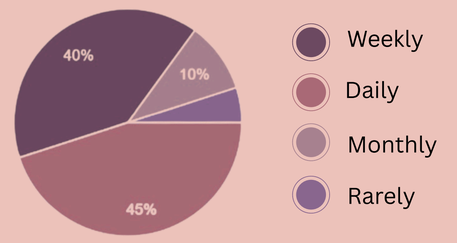
3 USER RESEARCH

Conducted surveys, interviews, and usability testing to understand user needs and mental health challenges.

Key Findings
Users experience stress frequently
Users want private journaling
Emergency support is important
Users prefer guided navigation
Privacy is a major concern

Key Insights
Simple and clear interface needed
Mood tracking and journaling are key features
Version B prototype improved usability and engagement

How often do you experience stress/anxiety/emotional distress?



4 Competitor Analysis and Decisions

Competitors	Strengths	Limitations	Our improvements
7 Cups	24/7 anonymous peer support.	Inconsistent advice and no professional continuity.	Structures peer templates, verified professionals and safety guardrails.
TalkLife	Strong community and AI moderation.	Overwhelming content, no clear guidance and clinical support.	Healing guides, dual user paths and professional escalation.
Airbnb	Humanised host profiles.	Not clinical.	All professionals have short introductory bio and tags denoting their area of specialization
Duolingo	Engaging streaks and micro tasks.	Can create pressure amongst users.	Positive reinforcement messaging as well as non-punitive engagement tracking.

DESIGN DECISIONS

Based on competitor analysis and UX benchmarking, HelpEra introduces:

- Structured peer support - reduces harmful or vague advice.
- "My Journey" continuity - no need to repeat experiences users can share journey.
- Micro-Guidance System - actionable steps with interactive exercises, not just venting.
- Dual User Paths - support for users and supporters.
- Transparency features - data clarity, progress tracking.
- Humanized Matching - Users choose professionals by preference

WHY OUR DESIGN IS BETTER COMPARED TO OTHERS

HelpEra improves existing solutions by:

- Combining peer and professional support in one platform.
- Reducing misinformation and overwhelm.
- Providing clear, actionable next steps not just emotional expression.
- Supporting both users and those who are helping others.
- Prioritizing safety, trust, and emotional comfort first.

5 USER PERSONA



Meet Tinashe K. Dube, a 22-year-old Junior Graphic Designer.
Tinashe:

- Skilled and proficient, but insecure
- Experiences workplace targeting and social anxiety.
- Is doubtful of his own work and perceives hostility from his superiors
- Feels anxious before submission of work
- He best reflects individuals who are more focused on digital validation rather than outspoken justice.

6 PAIN POINTS

Privacy: Users are unable to determine how their sensitive data is protected from being shared or leaked.

Support: Unclear guidelines on what to do during a crisis or resource(articles) are outdated.

Information Overload: Having too much content at once can be overwhelming to users.

Stability: Apps crash or freeze during use, causing users to lose their entries and data.

7 PROTOTYPE DEVELOPMENT & UI EVOLUTION

The HelpEra prototype was developed iteratively, evolving from low-fidelity wireframes into a fully interactive high-fidelity mobile experience. Early wireframes established layout, navigation, and core user flows, which were refined into visually consistent screens with improved hierarchy and usability. The final design supports seamless navigation across key features such as check-ins, learning resources, community interaction, and professional support, ensuring a clear, accessible, and user-centred experience.

8 THE OUTCOME

The final solution is a high-fidelity mobile prototype built on a "Heal, Connect, and Reflect" framework. Utilizing a calming "Glassmorphism" aesthetic, the interface reduces the "clinical feel" typical of health apps, transforming mental health tracking into an intuitive daily habit. Users can seamlessly transition from identifying a mood to accessing guided self-care, professional matching, or emergency SOS resources, ensuring that support is always just one tap away.